09-08 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Three Minutes I Thought Would Never End

① I had always been the kind of girl who spoke softly in class — often too softly. When teachers asked a question, my hand moved halfway up, then went back down, the way a nervous bird lands on a wire and then flies away again. So, when our English teacher said in early autumn that every Grade 8 student **must** give a three-minute speech in our class speech week, my heart sank like a stone. Three **minutes**. In front of **forty-two** people. In **English**. I counted the number of times I had willingly spoken in front of strangers in my whole life: **two**. Both were at bus stations, and both involved the word "excuse me".

② I chose the title in one shaking hour: **"The Quiet Window of My Grandmother's Kitchen."** It was not a big topic. It was not a clever topic. It was the topic of an ordinary kitchen window in my grandmother's old courtyard house, and how, every summer holiday, I sat by that window and watched the slow neighbourhood — a cat crossing the roof, an old man sharpening his tools, my grandmother kneading dough with patient hands. My mother read the draft, smiled quietly, and said, "This is yours. Don't try to sound like someone on TV."

③ For two weeks I practised in front of the bathroom mirror. Every evening after homework, I closed the door, turned on a soft light, and whispered the speech to my own reflection. The girl in the mirror looked pale and serious, as if she had not slept enough. When I reached the line, "**My grandmother's kitchen taught me to love slowness**," my voice sometimes cracked. Even to myself.

④ The morning of the speech came faster than I had expected. My English teacher had placed twenty-eight small slips of paper in a small tin, each with a name. When she pulled out the third name — "**Chen Linyi**" — my stomach made a small, cold jump. I stood up on legs that did not feel like mine, walked to the front, and looked at the sea of faces. Someone in the back coughed. Someone else dropped a pencil, and it rolled slowly across the wooden floor, making a long, thin sound. The silence was enormous.

⑤ I opened my mouth. My first sentence came out, but my voice was **thin**, like a pencil line on paper. I looked up; the teacher smiled gently, as if to say, "take your time." I took one slow breath. Then I remembered what my mother had said the night before: "Your grandmother's kitchen is not scared of a classroom." I spoke the next sentence a little more slowly. Then the next.

⑥ Somewhere in the middle, I stopped hearing my own voice as "**a performance**". I was only describing **what I had seen** — the dusty yellow jar of sugar, the small green teapot, the way my grandmother hummed an old song while chopping spring onions. I could almost hear the tea boiling, almost smell the dough warming in the sun. When I looked up for a moment, I noticed that several classmates were looking straight at me, and not in a mean way. Ma Jia, who usually sat with crossed arms, had put both elbows on the desk, chin on her hands, listening.

⑦ I reached my last sentence: "**The quiet window of my grandmother's kitchen did not teach me English grammar, but it taught me something in any language — how to stand still.**" I stopped. There was half a second of complete silence. Then the class clapped — not wildly, but in a steady, warm way, like rain on a rooftop that is friendly, not angry. Our English teacher looked at me for one second longer than she looked at the others, and nodded very slowly.

⑧ Back at my desk, my legs still felt a little strange, but my heart was surprisingly calm. The second, the third, and the fourth speaker began their speeches. I did not hear much; I was still in a quiet kitchen, 300 kilometres away, watching a cat cross a roof. In the break, Ma Jia walked over. "Your grandma sounds cool," she said. Then, in a lower voice: "I was scared of my speech too. Thank you for going third." She smiled, a small quick smile, and walked away before I could answer.

⑨ That evening I wrote one line in my notebook: "**Today my voice shook for forty-one seconds and then stopped shaking.**" I underlined it twice. I have given three more speeches since then — at a Grade 8 English club, at a Mid-Autumn evening, and once in a small city event. My legs still feel strange before every one. But I know now the strange feeling will **end**. A quiet grandmother, a slow kitchen window, and a mother who believed in my voice made sure of that.

注释： dough 面团；reflection 镜中映像；knead 揉面；enormous 巨大的；hum 哼唱

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why was the writer especially worried about the class speech?

A. Because she was the best speaker in her class.
B. Because the speech had to be three minutes, in English, in front of 42 people, and she had willingly spoken in front of strangers only about twice in her whole life.
C. Because the speech was about maths.
D. Because the speech had to be 30 minutes long.

2. Which of the following best describes the writer's speech topic?

A. A famous person she had never met.
B. A summer trip to a foreign country.

C. The quiet window of her grandmother's ordinary kitchen, and what she saw from it.
D. Her own computer games.

3. How did the writer feel after her first sentence came out "thin, like a pencil line on paper"?

A. She immediately sat down and cried.
B. She took a slow breath, remembered her mother's words, and continued speaking a little more slowly.
C. She ran out of the classroom.
D. She started speaking in Chinese instead.

4. What did the writer realise somewhere in the middle of her speech?

A. That she had forgotten her text completely.
B. That she was no longer thinking of her speech as "a performance", but was simply describing what she had seen in the kitchen.
C. That the teacher was angry with her.
D. That the classroom was on fire.

5. What does the writer mainly want to say in her final notebook entry, "Today my voice shook for forty-one seconds and then stopped shaking"?

A. That she will never speak in public again.
B. That fear at the beginning of a speech is real but it eventually stops — and the courage to try again can be learnt.
C. That she spoke for only forty-one seconds.
D. That she wasted forty-one seconds of her life.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "Three minutes. In front of forty-two people. In English. ... willingly spoken in front of strangers in my whole life: two"
【解析】原因即三要素加之极少公开发言经验。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "'The Quiet Window of My Grandmother's Kitchen' ... the slow neighbourhood"
【解析】演讲题目即外婆厨房的窗与缓慢日常。A、B、D 均不合。故选 C。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "I took one slow breath. Then I remembered what my mother had said ... I spoke the next sentence a little more slowly"
【解析】她深呼吸并缓缓继续。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段 "I stopped hearing my own voice as 'a performance'. I was only describing what I had seen"
【解析】她不再把演讲视为表演，而是诚实地描述所见。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨/写作意图题
【定位】第⑨段 "my voice shook for forty-one seconds and then stopped shaking"；"I know now the strange feeling will end"
【解析】恐惧会结束，勇气可以训练。A、C、D 均误读。故选 B。